Xinyu Guan

Curriculum Vitae

Educational Leadership and Policy Analysis
University of Wisconsin-Madison
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Education

Exp. 2027 **Ph.D. Student, Educational Leadership and Policy Analysis**, *University of Wisconsin-Madison*, Madison, WI
Advisor: Christopher M. Saldaña

Completed **Ph.D. Minor, Quantitative Research Methods**, *University of Wisconsin-Madison*, Madison, WI
Department of Educational Psychology

2022 **M.A., Educational Leadership and Policy Analysis**, *University of Wisconsin-Madison*, Madison, WI
Concentration: Global Higher Education

2015 **B.A., Finance and Economics**, *McMaster University*, Hamilton, ON

Research Interests

K-12 school finance policy, practice, and politics; bilingual education policy; quantitative methods.

Professional & Academic Appointments

Sept 2025–Present **Project Assistant**, *Wisconsin Center for Education Research*, Madison, WI
Project: Comprehensive Assessment of Leadership for Learning/CALL Opportunities to Learn (CALL-OTL)
- Lead the validation of survey instruments utilizing exploratory factor analysis (EFA), confirmatory factor analysis (CFA), and a Rasch analysis.

2022–Aug 2025 **Research Assistant**, *Wisconsin Center for Education Research*, Madison, WI
Project 1: CALL/Equity-Centered Leadership (CALL/ECL)
- Conducted quantitative analysis of survey data using social network analysis (SNA) to map leadership interactions.
- Analyzed qualitative interview data to contextualize leadership practices within urban educational settings.

Project 2: CALL/Mapping Equity Indicators (CALL/MEI)
- Identified and aggregated public datasets to serve as evidence for equity indicators based on the NASEM framework.
- Developed novel equity indicators, evidence models, and data tools to measure both the processes and outcomes of equity-centered leadership.
- Contributed to key deliverables and technical reports prepared for the Wallace Foundation.

2023–2025 **Graduate Teaching Assistant**, *University of Wisconsin-Madison*, Madison, WI
- Designed and instructed a data science workshop for the Wisconsin Idea Executive Ph.D. Cohort.

2017–2019 **Cambridge Certified Teacher (TESOL)**, *New Oriental Education & Technology Group*, China

- Delivered English instruction to a diverse group of students in both classroom and individual instructional settings.

2015–2017 **Senior Financial Auditor**, *BDO China*, China

- Conducted comprehensive financial audits and prepared detailed reports for corporate clients in compliance with regulatory standards.

Peer-Reviewed Publications

Under Review **Guan, X.** & Saldaña, C.M. (2026). Examining the Distribution of K–12 Bilingual and Bicultural Aid in Wisconsin. *Educational Evaluation and Policy Analysis (EEPA)*.

2025 Saldaña, C.M. & **Guan, X.** (2025). Examining Trends and Patterns in K-12 School Security Expenditures in Texas. *Texas Education Review*.

2025 Molle, D., Liou, Y., Childs, J., Saldaña, C.M., Clifford, M., Awaludin, A., **Guan, X.**, Halverson, R., & Lee, Y. (2025). Exploring the Evolution of District-University Partnerships Focused on Equity-Centered Leadership. *The Journal of Professional Capital & Community*.

Conference Presentations & Proceedings

2025 **Guan, X.** (2025). A Three-Paper Analysis of Bilingual Education Funding Equity in Wisconsin. Presented at the University Council of Educational Administration (UCEA) Annual Conference, Puerto Rico.

2025 **Guan, X.** (2025). Early Access, Mixed Outcomes: Estimating the Effect of Bilingual Program Eligibility on Elementary Achievement in Wisconsin. Presented at the American Educational Research Association (AERA) Annual Meeting, Denver, CO.

2025 **Guan, X.**, Saldaña, C.M., & Romero, M. (2025). A Critical Policy Analysis of K-12 Bilingual Education Finance Policy in Wisconsin. Presented at the American Educational Research Association (AERA) Annual Meeting, Denver, CO.

2025 **Guan, X.**, Davalos, L., & Saldaña, C.M. (2025). Building FAIR School Finance Data Systems: A Multi-State and Federal Analysis. Presented at the Association for Education Finance and Policy (AEFP) Annual Conference, Washington, DC.

2025 Saldaña, C.M., Liou, Y. H., Molle, D., **Guan, X.**, et al. (2025). Examining School District Costs Associated with Designing, Implementing, and Operating Equity-Centered School Leadership Systems. Presented at the American Educational Research Association (AERA) Annual Meeting, Denver, CO (Symposium Session).

2024 **Guan, X.**, & Saldaña, C.M. (2024). Examining Trends and Patterns in K-12 School Security Expenditures in Texas. Presented at the University Council of Educational Administration (UCEA) Annual Conference, Los Angeles, CA.

2024 **Guan, X.** & Saldaña, C.M. (2024). Tracking Trends, Patterns, and Variation in K-12 School Security Spending in Texas. Presented at the Association for Education Finance and Policy Annual Conference, Baltimore, MD (Poster Session).

2024 **Guan, X.** & Saldaña, C.M. (2024). Equity in Action: Redesigning Funding Models for English Learners in Wisconsin. Presented at the University Council of Educational Administration Annual Conference, Los Angeles, CA.

2024 **Guan, X.**, Awaludin, A., & Halverson, R. R. (2024). Exploring Partnership Evolution in Support of Systems Change Toward Equity-Centered Leadership: A Mixed-Methods Social Network Analysis. Proceedings of the AERA Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, PA (Poster Session).

2024 Liou, Y. H., Saldaña, C.M., Clifford, M. A., Awaludin, A., **Guan, X.**, et al. (2024). Collaborating to Support Equity-Centered Leadership: A Two-Year Social Network Analysis of Eight Districts. Proceedings of the AERA Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, PA.

2023 Clifford, M. A., Molle, D., Halverson, R. R., Kallio, J. M., Saldaña, C.M., Awaludin, A., Childs, J., & **Guan, X.** (2023). Preparing for Innovation: Mapping Districts' Initial Efforts to Build Partnerships Around Equity-Centered Principal Pipelines. Proceedings of the AERA Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL.

Awards & Scholarships

2024–2026 **Barbara L. Jackson Scholar**, *University Council for Education Administration (UCEA)*

2026 **Graduate Student Travel Grant**, *School of Education, UW-Madison*

2024, 2025 **Henry Ahrnsbrak Student Support Scholarship**, *ELPA-GD*

2024 **Roe L. Johns Student Travel Grant**, *Association for Education Finance and Policy (AEFP)*

2022 **Russell T. Gregg Memorial Scholarship**, *ELPA-GD*

Methodological Skills & Training

Languages Stata, R, Python, LaTeX

Software Qualtrics, NVivo, MAXQDA, Zotero

Advanced Training Quasi-Experimental Design, Causal Inference, Randomized Field Experiments, Survey Design, Instrumental Variable & OLS Regression, Structural Equation Modeling (SEM), Multilevel Modeling (HLM), Mixed Methods, Applied Longitudinal Data Analysis

Workshops LINKS Center Workshop on Social Network Analysis, University of Kentucky (2023); Education Indicator Data Collaborative Workshop, Teachers College, Columbia University (2025)